

The Financial Security Scorecard

INCOME IS NOT SECURITY.
OPTIONS ARE SECURITY.

How dependent is your life on your next paycheck?

HOW TO USE Rate each area 0–3 based on where you are today. Circle one response per line and total your score.

01

CASH RUNWAY

If income stopped tomorrow, how long could I cover essential expenses?

Low score focus: build breathing room first.

CHECK-IN

0

<1 MO

1

1-2 MO

2

3-5 MO

3

6+ MO

02

FIXED COSTS

How much of my take-home income is already committed each month?

Low score focus: reduce what your life costs to maintain.

CHECK-IN

0

>80%

1

65-80%

2

50-64%

3

<50%

03

DEBT

How much does debt restrict my choices?

Low score focus: free up cash flow and reduce pressure.

CHECK-IN

0

HIGH

1

LIMITING

2

MANAGEABLE

3

MINIMAL

04

LIQUIDITY

How much of my safety net could I access quickly without selling long-term assets?

Low score focus: increase cash you can reach quickly.

CHECK-IN

0

VERY LOW

1

SOME

2

HEALTHY

3

STRONG

05

INCOME

If my primary income disappeared, what money would still come in?

Low score focus: add backup sources of income.

CHECK-IN

0

NONE

1

VERY LITTLE

2

MEANINGFUL

3

MULTIPLE

06

CAREER

How strong is my ability to generate income again?

Low score focus: invest in employability and visibility.

CHECK-IN

0

LIMITED

1

SOME

2

STRONG

3

VERY STRONG

07

WEALTH

Am I consistently converting income into assets for my future?

Low score focus: turn income into long-term ownership.

CHECK-IN

0

NOT YET

1

SOMETIMES

2

CONSISTENT

3

STRONG

YOUR FINANCIAL SECURITY GAP CHART

Total Score: _____ / 21

0–7	8–14	15–18	19–21
FINANCIALLY DEPENDENT	BUILDING RESILIENCE	FINANCIALLY FLEXIBLE	STRONG OPTIONALITY
One setback could create real pressure.	You have some stability, but still clear gaps.	You have meaningful room to maneuver.	Your finances give you real choices.

The point is not perfection. The goal is to create enough financial margin that one hard season does not decide your life.

THE REDHEAD ADVANTAGE™ • BUILD A LIFE YOU'RE PROUD OF.

Your Financial Security Option Bank

Use your lowest scores to explore practical ways to create more breathing room.

START WITH THE GAPS - NOT WITH EVERYTHING

These are options to consider, not a checklist you have to complete.

01 CASH RUNWAY

IF THIS IS A GAP...

Income stopping would create immediate pressure.

IDEAS TO EXPLORE

- Build a starter cash buffer, then work toward one month of essential expenses.
- Set an automatic transfer for each payday, even if the amount starts small.
- Direct part of a bonus, refund, sale, or other windfall toward your runway.
- Keep emergency cash separate from everyday spending so it is easier to protect.

05 INCOME

IF THIS IS A GAP...

One paycheck, client, or source carries most of your financial life.

IDEAS TO EXPLORE

- Strengthen your primary income through a raise, promotion, role change, or better-paying opportunity.
- Test a small second stream such as freelance, consulting, services, or a simple offer.
- Develop a skill that could create income independently of your current employer.
- Identify what you could realistically do to generate income within 30-60 days if needed.

02 FIXED COSTS

IF THIS IS A GAP...

Too much of your take-home pay is committed before the month begins.

IDEAS TO EXPLORE

- Audit subscriptions, memberships, insurance, phone, internet, and other recurring bills.
- Renegotiate or shop recurring services where switching is realistic for you.
- Pause new recurring commitments for 90 days while you lower your monthly baseline.
- Target one payment or expense that, once removed, permanently improves monthly cash flow.

06 CAREER

IF THIS IS A GAP...

Your ability to replace income is weaker than you want it to be.

IDEAS TO EXPLORE

- Update your resume, LinkedIn, portfolio, or professional profile before you need them.
- Reconnect with former colleagues and build relationships while there is no urgency.
- Write down quantified accomplishments and examples of the value you create.
- Research your market and close one skill or visibility gap that could improve earning power.

03 DEBT

IF THIS IS A GAP...

Debt payments limit your flexibility or create ongoing pressure.

IDEAS TO EXPLORE

- List balances, rates, minimums, and payoff terms so you can see the full picture.
- Prioritize high-interest debt or a payment that meaningfully improves cash flow.
- Redirect a paid-off minimum payment toward the next priority instead of absorbing it into spending.
- Avoid adding new high-interest consumer debt while you are actively reducing balances.

07 WEALTH

IF THIS IS A GAP...

Income is coming in, but too little is becoming long-term ownership.

IDEAS TO EXPLORE

- Automate a regular contribution to savings or investments that fits your plan.
- Review whether you are capturing available employer benefits or matching contributions.
- Consider directing part of future raises toward assets before lifestyle costs rise.
- Track net worth periodically so you can see whether income is becoming long-term security.

04 LIQUIDITY

IF THIS IS A GAP...

Your safety net is difficult to access quickly.

IDEAS TO EXPLORE

- Decide how much readily accessible cash would make you feel more secure.
- Build or increase a dedicated savings reserve for true emergencies.
- Separate emergency savings from sinking funds for planned expenses.
- Review which assets are actually accessible without selling long-term investments at an inconvenient time.

Choose - don't do everything.

Pick the 1-3 actions that would create the most breathing room in your circumstances over the next 90 days. A smaller plan you actually follow is more useful than a perfect plan you abandon.

Turn Your Score Into a 90-Day Plan

Choose the few moves that would most improve your security - then make them specific.

1. START WITH YOUR LOWEST SCORES

MY LOWEST AREA(S)
Where did I score 0 or 1?

THE BIGGEST LEVER
What change would create the most breathing room?

WHAT I CAN CONTROL NOW
What can I realistically influence in the next 90 days?

2. CHOOSE YOUR TOP 3 MOVES

Use the option bank for ideas. Make each move concrete enough that you will know when it is done.

#	FOCUS AREA	EXACT CHANGE	FIRST STEP THIS WEEK	TARGET DATE
01				
02				
03				

3. MAKE THE FIRST WEEK OBVIOUS

ONE THING I WILL DO IN THE NEXT 7 DAYS:

ONE THING I WILL PAUSE, REDUCE, OR STOP FOR 90 DAYS:

Financial security is built by creating options before you need them.

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